

1.3 Monitors



CRT or LCD? You decide...

Monitors remain the most-neglected device when it comes to upgrading. With prices taking a downturn, upgrading to a bigger monitor is not a bad idea at all. Newer monitors are more environment-friendly and generate less radiation. Moreover, you can turn in your old monitor and get a new one with a bit of reduction in price (as in a buy-back scheme).

A 17-inch monitor is the minimum you should opt for in CRTs, and a 15-inch in LCDs. However, there are pros and cons you have to understand when you're choosing a monitor. CRTs are excellent if you are an avid gamer or movie buff. The clarity and quality offered by a CRT in movies can't be compared to that on an LCD. But LCDs offer you space-saving designs and low power consumption, as well as a decent gaming and movie experience. Regular office work can be handled competently by either.

Where CRTs lose out is on their size: the bigger you choose, the greater the space it consumes on your desktop. LCDs, on the other